# 2015 Kia Forte LX

$5,111 · 153,873 miles · Dealer · Bakersfield, CA

Seller: Compas Auto Sales (3.7 stars, 154 reviews)

Source: AutosToday

Listing: https://www.autostoday.com/cars-for-sale/used-cars/listing/KNAFK4A64F5287947/2015-kia-forte-lx-auto-bakersfield-ca

Report generated October 30, 2026 · Ridgecrest Car Finder











+ 1 more photos in the app.

| Out-the-door price | Monthly cost to own | Reliability |
|---|---|---|
| **$5,930** | **$483** | **Average** |
| Set a budget in the Cost Calculator tab to compare. | loan + insurance + fuel + repairs + registration | 3/5 · 1 recalls · 260 NHTSA complaints |

## Budget — buying it

| | |
|---|---|
| Vehicle price | $5,111.00 |
| Sales tax (9.25%) | $472.77 |
| Dealer doc + filing fees | $125.00 |
| Vehicle license fee (0.65% of price) | $33.22 |
| Registration + CHP fee | $108.00 |
| Transportation improvement fee | $65.00 |
| Title transfer | $15.00 |
| Total out-the-door | $5,929.99 |
| + Pre-purchase inspection (you pay the shop) | $150.00 |

California taxes the full price — a trade-in does not reduce sales tax. DMV fees are estimates; the CA DMV fee calculator gives exact amounts.

## Budget — paying for it

| | |
|---|---|
| Down payment | $5,000.00 |
| Amount financed | $929.99 |
| Monthly loan payment (60 mo @ 7.5% APR) | $18.64 |
| Total interest over the loan | $188.12 |
| Cash needed up front (down payment + inspection) | $5,150.00 |

## Budget — owning it each month

| | |
|---|---|
| Loan payment | $18.64 |
| Insurance (estimate, full) | $135.00 |
| Fuel (1,000 mi/mo @ 29 MPG, $4.75/gal) | $163.79 |
| Maintenance & repair reserve | $150.00 |
| Registration renewal (÷12) | $15.27 |
| Total per month | $482.70 |

Running costs without the loan: **$464/mo**. Estimated first-year cost of ownership: **$11,713** (out-the-door + inspection + 12 months of running costs + loan interest).

The repair reserve is set from the reliability rating and mileage: money to set aside, not a forecast.

## Insurance

| Coverage | Typical Ridgecrest range | Estimate used |
|---|---|---|
| Liability only (CA minimum 30/60/15) | $49–$112/mo | $70/mo |
| Full coverage (liability + collision + comprehensive) | $94–$243/mo | $135/mo |

The budget above uses the **full coverage** estimate ($135/mo). Get real quotes and enter one in the app to replace it.

• Vehicle class: typical car. Estimates assume an adult driver with a clean record; age, record, credit, and coverage limits change the price a lot.

• Ridgecrest is one of the cheapest places in California to insure a car (about $107–110/mo average).

• A lender will require full coverage. On an older, cheap car paid in cash, liability-only can make sense — but you'd pay for your own repairs after an at-fault accident.

• California's minimum (30/60/15) is low; $100k/$300k/$100k liability is commonly recommended.

• Ask about military/government discounts (NAWS China Lake), bundling, and low-mileage discounts.

## Reliability

**Rating: Average (3/5)**

The 2014-18 Forte with the 1.8L is average: simple and cheap to fix, not part of the big Kia/Hyundai 2.0/2.4 engine recalls, but check for oil use at high miles.

NHTSA data for this model year: 1 recalls · 260 owner complaints (16 involving a crash). Most complaints: Engine (158), Unknown Or Other (31), Electrical System (29), Air Bags (23), Power Train (17), Service Brakes (16).

**Known issues for this model**

• Oil consumption at high mileage

• Steering coupler clunk (fix is cheap)

• A/C condenser

• Accident on record - inspect repairs

**Check on this car before buying**

• No check-engine light; scan for codes

• Oil level

• Steering clunk over bumps

• Body/paint around the repaired area

## Notes

$5,111 (about $5,867 out the door), 153,873 mi. AutoCheck: clean title, ACCIDENT REPORTED, 1 previous owner (lease). 29% below market; listed 102 days - very negotiable.

Cheapest option in the range and the newest car under $5,500. Same dealer as the 2012 Civic Hybrid. Ask about the accident and inspect before buying.

## Vetting checklist (0/12 done)

- [ ] Checked KBB/Edmunds fair price
- [ ] Recalls checked / completed
- [ ] Clean title in seller's name
- [ ] Test drive incl. highway & hills
- [ ] No overheating; coolant clean
- [ ] Pre-purchase inspection
- [ ] VIN decoded & matches listing
- [ ] History report (Carfax/AutoCheck/NMVTIS)
- [ ] Valid smog cert (< 90 days)
- [ ] A/C cold after 15+ min
- [ ] Tires OK (tread, dry-rot, DOT date)
- [ ] Written out-the-door price

All costs and insurance figures are estimates for planning, not quotes. Confirm fees with the CA DMV, rates with insurers, and the car's condition with an independent pre-purchase inspection.